

Ankit Raj

Platform Engineering & Product Leader - Cloud, DevOps & Internal Developer Platforms

Stockholm, Sweden | rajankit749@gmail.com | ankitraj.cloud | linkedin.com/in/raj-ankit | github.com/restlessankyyy

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Platform engineering and product leader with 10+ years shaping the strategy, direction, and delivery of internal platforms consumed across large enterprises in financial services, automotive, and retail. I define platform product strategy across cloud, data, and integration layers, then turn it into consumable tech stacks, golden-path templates, and reference architectures that let business teams move fast within governed, compliant frameworks. Proven at embedding governance, security, and compliance into platforms by default, so teams are compliant by design rather than by approval. Fluent in modern SDLC and toolchains (CI/CD, workflow automation, infrastructure as code) with a track record of measurable improvements in platform delivery and consumption, 200+ product teams onboarded and 35% cost reduction. A people-first leader who translates strategy into actionable roadmaps, develops engineers to their full potential, and partners with executives across Risk, Compliance, and Security to connect platform investment to time-to-market, resilience, and cost efficiency.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Platform Product Strategy	Platform-as-a-Product, Product Roadmaps, Service & Consumption Models, Golden Paths, Reference Tech Stacks, Portfolio Alignment
Internal Developer Platforms	Self-Service Provisioning, Developer Portals (Backstage / Cycloid), Paved Roads, Platform Adoption & Enablement
Cloud & Integration	Azure, AWS, Google Cloud - Architecture, Migration & Governance; Event-Driven & API Integration Layers; Data Platforms
Modern SDLC & Toolchains	CI/CD (GitHub Actions), Workflow Automation, Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Bicep), DevOps, DORA Metrics
Governance & Compliance	Governance-by-Default, Risk / Compliance / Security Partnership, RBAC, Policy-as-Code, Landing Zones, Regulatory Controls
AI-Powered Automation	GenAI / LLM Workflow Automation, Agentic Delivery Tooling, Prompt Engineering, MLOps, Productivity Tooling
Leadership & Influence	Team Development & Coaching, Executive Stakeholder Management, Strategy-to-Execution, Data-Driven Decisions, Inclusive Culture
Languages	TypeScript, Python, JavaScript, Go, SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Platform & Cloud Architect - Internal Platforms & Multi-Cloud

2024 - Present

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Define and drive the platform product strategy across cloud, data, and integration layers, shaping a coherent portfolio of internal capabilities consumed by 200+ product teams and aligned to long-term business strategy
- Established the service and consumption model that lets business teams access shared technology predictably and safely, implementing Cycloid as the internal developer platform with self-service provisioning and golden-path Terraform stacks
- Set cloud and tech-stack direction through reference architectures, paved-road patterns, and golden paths that give teams freedom to move fast within governed, compliant frameworks
- Embedded governance by default, partnering across Risk, Compliance, and Security to translate regulatory and security requirements into platform controls (policy-as-code, RBAC, landing zones) for 1,600+ subscriptions, making teams compliant by design rather than by approval
- Translated platform value into business outcomes, building metrics and executive narrative that connected investment to time-to-market, operational resilience, and a 35% reduction in cloud spend via a multi-million SEK FinOps programme
- Drove measurable improvements in platform delivery and consumption using AI-powered automation, embedding GenAI workflows and agentic tooling into golden paths to accelerate delivery and simplify standardised practices
- Developed the team by coaching and upskilling 8+ engineers, authoring blueprints and workshops, and nurturing a culture of trust, ownership, and continuous learning

Lead Software Engineer - Platform Engineering

2023 - 2024

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Engineered the multi-cloud platform backbone on Azure & Google Cloud, achieving 99.9% uptime SLA for 200+ product teams across global operations
- Designed and built an Internal Developer Platform with self-service provisioning (EventGrid + Functions), reducing team onboarding from days to minutes and driving platform consumption
- Evaluated, benchmarked, and shipped AI/ML and developer-productivity tooling into the platform, improving team velocity by 40%
- Ran deep-dive architecture and design reviews, creating reusable patterns and reference stacks adopted across teams

Senior Software Engineer - Distributed Systems & Integration

2020 - 2023

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Designed a Zero Trust microservices architecture (15+ services, sub-100ms p99), demonstrating deep infrastructure, integration, and security expertise
- Built high-throughput GraphQL & REST integration APIs handling 50K+ RPM across distributed systems with automated scaling and rate limiting
- Led CI/CD standardisation with GitHub Actions across 200+ repositories, reaching 95% pipeline success and establishing DevOps golden paths at enterprise scale
- Resolved complex cross-system technical blockers through root-cause analysis, improving platform reliability and developer experience

Cloud Solutions Architect Consultant - FSI Data & AI

2019 - 2020

Cognizant - Ikano Bank, Stockholm

- Strategic technical advisor to a financial services client - architected migration of AML & KYC data and APIs from on-premises to a serverless, event-driven platform, reducing latency by 70%
- Designed scalable data and integration architecture (Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, Step Functions) handling 500K+ daily transactions with Terraform IaC and CloudWatch observability
- Designed a scripted, rules-based automation framework for code and API policy conversion - reusable IP that cut migration delivery time by 60% through templated, repeatable tooling
- Delivered executive proof-of-concept demonstrations, driving alignment and commitment for full cloud and data adoption under shifting priorities

Cloud Solutions Architect Consultant - Automotive

2019 - 2020

Cognizant - Volvo Cars, Gothenburg

- Trusted technical advisor to engineering teams - designed and delivered an enterprise observability and analytics platform (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus) on AKS monitoring 100+ microservices
- Managed CI/CD pipelines for OpenShift & Kubernetes with Azure DevOps - reduced deployment cycle time from hours to 15 minutes
- Authored architecture documentation and runbooks - achieving 99.5% SLA compliance and translating requirements into measurable outcomes

Cognizant Technology Solutions

- Designed and delivered cloud architectures and CI/CD pipelines (CodePipeline, Docker, ECS/Fargate) for 5+ enterprise clients across industry verticals
- Built a Cloud Management Dashboard for real-time infrastructure visibility and cost analytics, driving measurable business impact
- Won 1st place at Enterprise AWS Game Day 2018 (200+ participants) and mentored client teams to build cloud fluency

KEY PLATFORM INITIATIVES

Internal Developer Platform & Golden Paths (H&M Group)

Implemented Cycloid as the internal developer portal with self-service provisioning, golden-path Terraform stacks, and integrated FinOps visibility across Azure, AWS, and GCP for 200+ product teams, standardising how business teams consume shared technology.

Governance-by-Default & FinOps Platform (H&M Group)

Multi-agentic AI system and policy-as-code framework embedding security, compliance, and cost governance directly into platform capabilities, reducing multi-million SEK cloud spend and making 1,600+ subscriptions compliant by design.

Serverless Platform Migration (Ikano Bank)

Automated migration tooling for policy conversion, code analysis, and IaC scaffolding, delivering repeatable platform IP that cut migration time 60% and 70% latency for regulated AML/KYC workloads.

Rubin - AI Coding Assistant (Open Source / GitHub)

Privacy-first local AI coding assistant with 14-tool agent mode, MCP integration, and streaming chat, demonstrating AI-powered developer-productivity tooling and platform product thinking. TypeScript, VS Code API.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) - Exam 533: Azure Infrastructure
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Microsoft OpenHack: AI-Powered Knowledge Mining · Containers · Security, Compliance & Identity · DevOps
- Google India Udacity Scholar

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Computer Science & Engineering

2012 - 2016

Galgotias University, Greater Noida, India

Specialisation in Cloud Computing & Virtualisation. Projects: IoT Heart Rate Monitor, Big Data Analytics.

PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

I Gave an AI Agent Root Access to a Sandboxed Linux Box - AI agent sandbox experiment (Medium)

What is Kubernetes? - Container orchestration deep-dive (FAUN / Medium)

Building Apps on Google Cloud Run - Serverless deployment patterns (Medium)

Azure DevOps is the new VSTS - Enterprise DevOps transformation (Medium)